

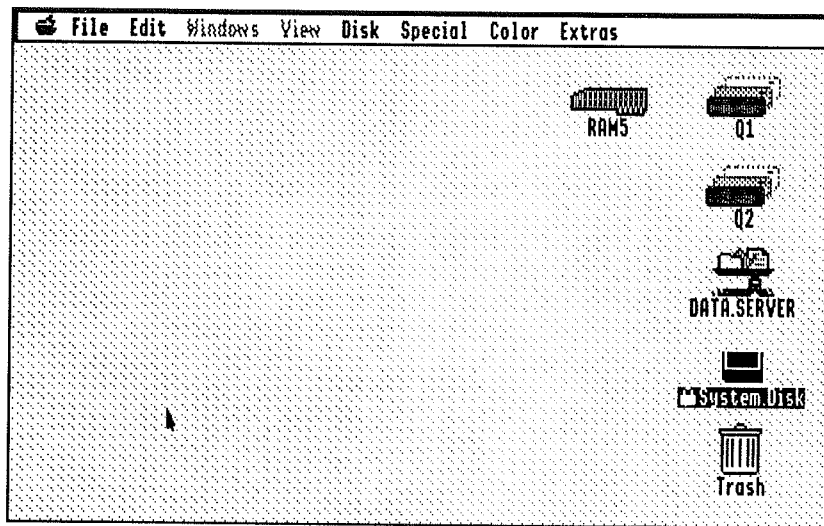


Figure 6B—The Apple II GS Finder

Folders are files that *contain* other files; you can use them to keep the contents of your disks organized. Folders can even contain other folders. Folders are really a special kind of file that the computer uses to keep a list of the things you've placed "inside" the folder, but they're often considered separately from other types of files because of their special properties. When a discussion applies both files and folders, we'll use both terms.

Note!

In the exercises we're about to do—selecting, coloring, renaming, and dragging icons—we'll just be using the disk icons on your desktop (and the Trash) to keep the examples simple. The principles you'll learn, however, apply to all Finder icons, including files and folders.

Working With Icons

Selecting Icons

The Finder, like all Desktop programs, uses the object-action method: first you tell the Finder what object(s) you want to work with, then you tell it what action to perform. Objects (disks, documents, and programs) are represented by icons. Actions are selected from the pull-down menus or performed directly on the icons by manipulating them with the mouse. So before you do anything with the Finder, you tell it which icon you want to do something to.

You select individual icons by clicking them once. Try it—click any icon on the desktop and watch it turn black. Click another. The first icon you clicked returns to its original coloring, and the new icon is selected.